TASK 5 CASE-STUDY

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UPI fraud is a common type of cybercrime where attackers trick users into revealing sensitive information or approving fraudulent transactions. This type of fraud often targets students and individuals who frequently use digital payment apps.

A typical scenario begins when the victim receives a phone call or message claiming to be from a bank official or payment service. The fraudster creates urgency by saying there is an issue with the account or a reward to be claimed. They then send a fake payment request or a malicious link. Step-by-step, the victim is persuaded to click the link or approve a “collect request” on their UPI app. In some cases, the victim is asked to share an OTP or PIN, which gives the attacker full access to their account.

Once access is gained, money is quickly transferred out of the victim’s account. The consequences include financial loss, stress, and sometimes difficulty in recovering the lost amount. Students are often targeted because they may not be fully aware of such scams.

This case highlights the importance of never sharing OTPs or PINs, carefully verifying payment requests, and avoiding suspicious links.

Awareness and cautious behaviour are key to preventing such cybercrimes.